

that can simplify the process.

New operating concepts are among this year's dominant home entertainment trends. Many TVs can already be remotely operated via a tablet or smartphone, eliminating the need for a remote control. Now the first consumer electronics devices, in particular TVs, that are capable of reacting to voice and gesture commands are coming onto the market.

One example is Samsung's smart TV. With this TV, a simple gesture is all it takes to access your favourite movies, sports, apps and other smart content. Forget the remote. Instead, use your hands to control TV functions by swiping to navigate and grabbing to select.

4 Smart TVs

Conventional broadcasts are not the only thing that smart TVs can receive. These can also access Internet content and services. Owners can start apps on-screen, play games with partners in the cloud, take out films from media theques, or keep in touch with friends through e-mails,



Smart TV by LG

Skype, Twitter or Facebook.

The technology which device manufacturers have developed to get Web content varies, although the different methods they use all look very similar. In addition to apps, some smart TVs also feature browsers that can surf the Internet similar to a PC. Special apps for smartphones and tablets connected to the living room TV via a wireless home network feature virtual keyboards that make navigating on-screen content especially easy.

Products vary depending on the manufacturer. Some companies have already set up developer communities for TV apps in order to concentrate the creative potential within the IT scene and to rapidly increase the diversity available in the market.

By 2011 some six million Internet TVs had already been

sold. According to market researchers, in 2012 every second set sold in Germany will be a smart TV. The current market volume stands at 5.5 million sets.

The gradual convergence of television and the Internet over the last three years will become an even more dominant market trend, both in 2012 and beyond. It is not just a technology trend but one that also defines a new business model approach within the consumer electronics industry. In future, the degree to which companies can combine device features with content services and the degree to which hardware manufacturers and content providers can cooperate across individual business sectors will significantly determine the level of their success.

5 Second screens—a second display on one's lap

Smart TVs capable of accessing both the Web for entertainment as well as hard drives and computers via a home network in order to automatically search for photos, music and images present a challenge in terms of ergonomics. Digitally navigating one's way with only a few cursor keys requires a great deal of patience.

Tablets and smartphones provide the answer. In future, these will evolve into universal navigators of media services and functions. The way in which a large living room TV set interacts with a miniature wireless display on the viewer's lap will be among the most exciting innovations.

One of the many operating scenarios is as follows: A digital camera forms part of a W-LAN home network, which both a TV set and tablet are able to automatically recognise. Touching the camera icon on the tablet shows an overview of the user's last photos. Swiping the tablet display in the direction of the TV set starts up a slideshow of the photos on the large-screen TV.

6 Ultrabooks—between tablets and notebooks

Last year tablets were the big hit. In 2012, ultrabooks are setting a new trend. These are extremely thin, have extended battery life, boot up in seconds and sport handsome looks. Some models even let the user decide whether to operate



XPS ultrabook by Dell